CHECKLIST

Spot the slot machine

Three questions to ask of any app that keeps pulling you back. It's a way to notice a pattern. It doesn't diagnose the app, or you.

App I'm checking: _____

Pick one app. Open it and use it for two minutes as you normally would. Then tick what you noticed.

1. How short is the loop?

- ☐ One pull, swipe or tap gives me the next thing
- ☐ There is no natural stopping point
- ☐ The next item arrives in a second or two

In the video: Online slots in the UK must take at least 2.5 seconds per game (a Gambling Commission requirement). Does your feed leave any gap at all?

2. How unpredictable is the reward?

- ☐ I can't tell whether the next one will be good
- ☐ Sometimes it's great, and most of the time it isn't
- ☐ Refreshing might give me something new, or nothing

In the video: The flushing toilet only becomes a slot machine once the outcome is unpredictable.

3. How tuned is it to me?

- ☐ What I see changes based on what I did before
- ☐ It seems to know what holds my attention
- ☐ A friend's version of the app would look different

In the video: Personalisation is the third lever: the more it is tuned to you, the harder it is to put down.

What I noticed:

How to read it

- Ticks under all three questions: the pattern is strong in this app.
- Ticks under one or two: it is partly there.
- No ticks: this app is not pulling on these levers.

These bands are my own rule of thumb, a starting guess and not a validated scale. Knowing the pattern doesn't switch it off. It gives you the chance to notice it sooner.

"A friend's version would look different" is my own plain-language test for personalisation, not a research finding.

From the video "How intermittent rewards work: explained with a flushing toilet".
The 3-minute phone check-in: **mornsolar.vercel.app/check/**